Panels

From the complex of Sultan Qalawun (683-84 AH / 1284-85 CE)

Tulunid, 3rd century AH / 9th century CE

W: 42 cm; H: 20.8 cm

Inv. no. 4132, 4133



Carved in the beveled style on both sides, these two panels bear traces of successive interventions: earlier motifs on the reverse were flattened in order to affix them to a backing, allowing the refined designs on the obverse to be displayed. Their recorded provenance from the complex of Sultan Qalawun is intriguing: the beveled style had fallen out of fashion by the time the complex was built in the Mamluk period, leaving open the question of whether the panels were original to the site or had found their way there from elsewhere.

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